



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 01: Introduction to Public Speaking

Prof. Binod Mishra

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



What is Public Speaking?

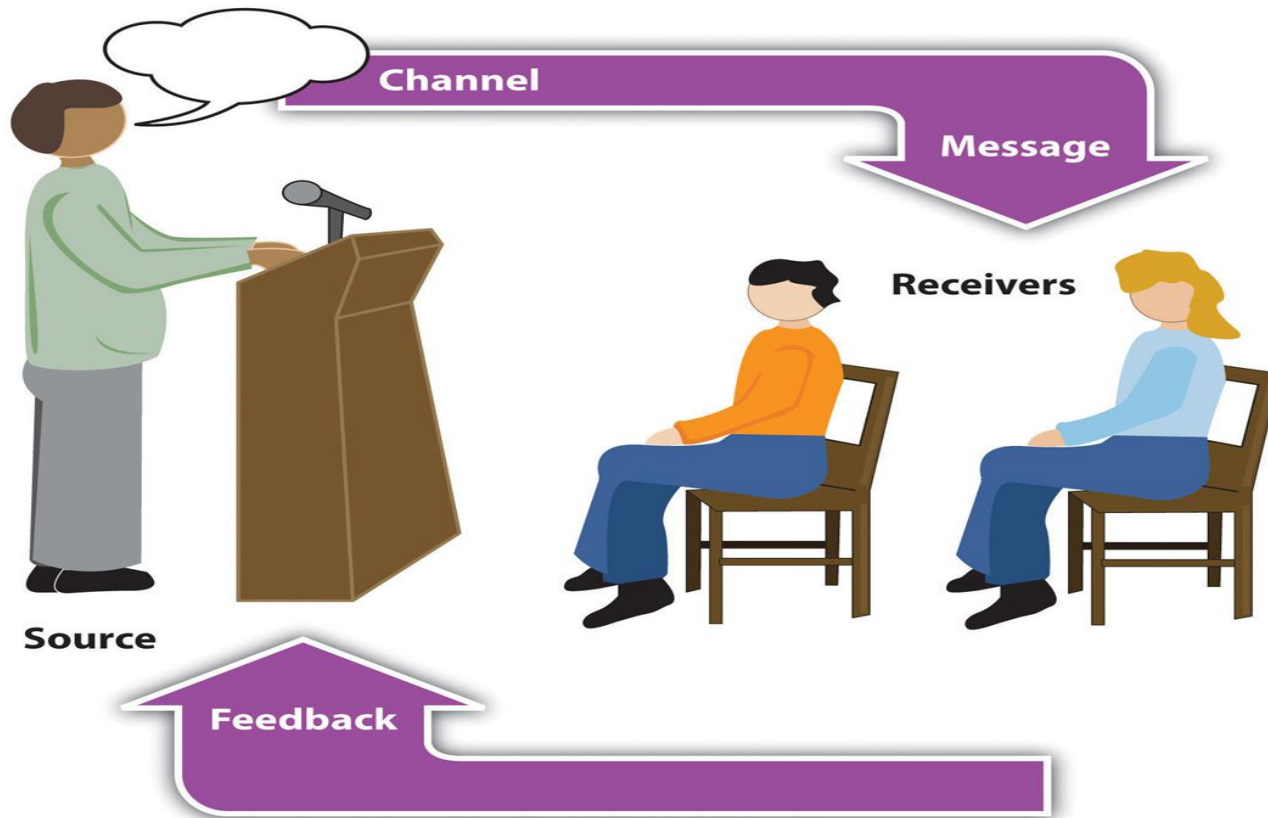
- ❖ According to Merriam Webster Dictionary , Public Speaking is “the act or process of making speeches in public” or “the art of effective oral communication with an audience”
- ❖ “Speech is power: speech is to persuade , to convert, to compel” - Ralph Waldo Emerson
- ❖ To be successful, says business leader Midge Costanza, you must have “the ability to stand on your feet, either on a one-to-one basis or before a group, and make a presentation that is convincing and believable” (Lucas 34).

Advent of Public Speaking

- The inception of Public Speaking in Greece and Rome as a discipline dates 2,500 years ago.
- The famous Greek scholar Aristotle (384-322 BCE) laid the foundation in his treatise titled *Rhetoric* - the first book on Public Speaking.
- Roman educator Quintilian, Christian preacher St. Augustine, the medieval writer Christine de Pizan, British philosopher Francis Bacon, Nelson Mandela, Hillary Clinton and many others have magnified the power of public speaking.

Public Speaking and its Development

- ❑ 21st Century witnessed the advancements in the discourse of Public Speaking.
- ❑ Due to technical advancements, different forms of public speaking have surfaced and are thriving in the contemporary times.
- ❑ Besides the physical communication, new platforms for Public Speaking like **Ted Talk**, **YouTube broadcasting**, **Video conferencing**, and **Podcasts** are vested with the power to inspire, educate, entertain and persuade the viewers or the listeners.



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Public Speaking as a Form of Communication

- Communication plays a chief role in public speaking.
- Effective communication is the backbone of public speaking.
- Effective communication ensures the message reaches the audience in its correct and desired form.
- Speaking with confidence is mandatory.
- Style of communication also plays an important role in public speaking.

Public Speaking Vs. Everyday Communication

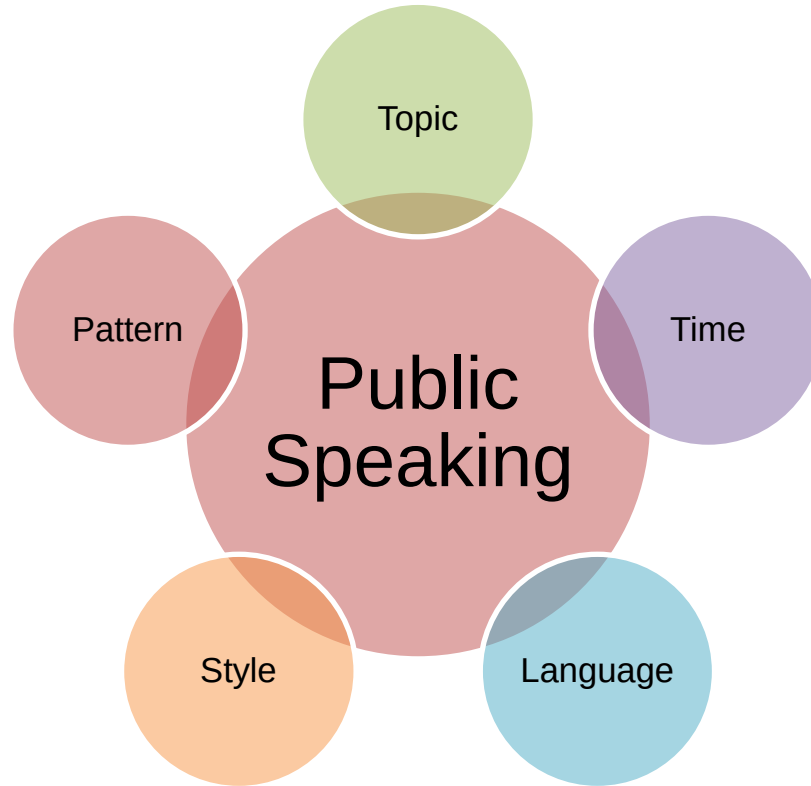
- Public Speaking is **not an everyday routine**.
- Public speech is **special** and it is delivered on occasions of importance.
- Attributes of Public Speaking:
 - ✓ More structured and not spontaneous
 - ✓ Time constraint
 - ✓ Formal and Decent language
 - ✓ Proper body language and mannerism
 - ✓ Avoiding jargons, colloquial expressions or slangs
 - ✓ Avoiding non-lexical fillers



Public Speaking- An Exercise in Critical Thinking

- ✓ Ability to form your own judgments
- ✓ Analyze and understand different points of view
- ✓ Verify the facts
- ✓ Recognize a speaker's biased/unstated assumptions
- ✓ Broaden one's canvas of thoughts

Ingredients of Public Speaking



Beneficiaries

- There are more avenues to reach people than ever before, but there is no substitute for face-to-face communication



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Domains of Public Speaking - I

Entrepreneurial Communication:

- Interviews
- Leadership
- Meetings
- Group Discussions
- Negotiations

Domains of Public Speaking- II

Classroom/ Scholarly Communication

- Student-teacher communication
- Elocutions
- Recitations
- Debates
- Conferences and Symposiums

Impediments to Public Speaking

- Nervousness
- Inept Delivery
- Lack of Coherence
- Negligent Listening
- Content divorced from Occasion

Advantages of Public Speaking in diverse fields

- Technical
- Financial
- Bureaucracy
- Aesthetic

Iconic Speech

"Long years ago we made a tryst with destiny, and now the time comes when we shall redeem our pledge, not wholly or in full measure, but very substantially. At the stroke of the midnight hour, when the world sleeps, India will awake to life and freedom. A moment comes, which comes but rarely in history, when we step out from the old to new, when an age ends, and when the soul of a nation, long suppressed, finds utterance..."

- Jawaharlal Nehru

“And now, as you graduate to begin anew, I wish that
for you. Stay Hungry. Stay Foolish.”

- Steve Jobs

Thank You

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